

Sentiment Journey Diary

System Spec & Data Schema · v1.1 · May 2026

1 · What This Artifact Is

The Sentiment Journey Diary is a data-driven emotional tracking system for the PMD project journey. It captures quantitative confidence ratings alongside rich qualitative retrospective content for every project — then generates dynamic visual infographics from that data on demand.

The core output is a horizontal hiker-on-a-path infographic: a small village at the left (P0 origin), a distant mountain summit at the right (long-term vision), and an emotional terrain between them showing peaks and valleys mapped to real project outcomes. The path scales dynamically — narrow views focus on 3–5 current projects with full detail, wide macro views show the complete arc with summary-level content.

The infographic serves multiple output contexts: thepmddev.com homepage feature, branded blog post hero banners, social post assets, and — in a later phase — an embedded interactive React component on a dedicated Journey page.

2 · Two-Layer Architecture

Layer	File	Purpose	Grows over time?
Data source	<code>PMD_Sentiment_Data.json</code>	Structured log of every project entry — ratings, retro bullets, metadata	Yes — one entry added per project close
Generator	<code>generate_sentiment_infographic.py</code>	Reads the JSON, renders the infographic at requested zoom level, outputs PDF + PNG	No — script is stable, re-run on demand

The data source and the generator are intentionally separate. The JSON grows with every project. The generator is stateless — it reads whatever entries exist and renders the requested view. Re-running the generator at any time produces an updated infographic without modifying historical data.

3 · PMD_Sentiment_Data.json — Complete Schema

All cells wrapped in Paragraph objects per locked PDF pattern. The JSON schema below defines every field, its type, and its purpose.

v1.1 changes from v1.0: peak_valley removed — terrain derived from confidence_score by generator. exceeded_expectations and fell_short consolidated into self_assessment object — eliminates redundancy with worked_well and tricky. content_log_items and next_project_intent promoted to required — optional fields do not get filled. duration field added — project cadence is evaluator-relevant signal. horizon array added — provides the forward-looking runway the infographic needs to render upcoming projects.

Field	Type	Required	Description
schema_version	string	Yes	Schema version identifier — e.g. '1.1'. Increment when fields are added.
generated	string	Yes	ISO 8601 date of last data update — e.g. '2026-05-01'.
journey.origin	string	Yes	Label for the path start — e.g. 'P0 · Portfolio Shell'.
journey.destination	string	Yes	Label for the distant summit — e.g. 'Full-Stack PM · Hired'.
projects[]	array	Yes	Ordered array of completed project entries. One object per project, in completion order.
projects[].id	string	Yes	Unique project identifier — e.g. 'P0', 'P1'.
projects[].name	string	Yes	Short display name — e.g. 'Portfolio Shell'.
projects[].phase_range	string	Yes	Phase span completed — e.g. 'Phases 1–9'.
projects[].completed	string	Yes	Completion date — e.g. 'May 2026'.
projects[].duration	string	Yes	How long the project took — e.g. '6 weeks', '3 sessions'. Cadence is evaluator-relevant signal on the macro view.
projects[].classification	string	Yes	'portfolio' or 'learning'. Locked at kickoff Step 3.
projects[].confidence_score	number	Yes	Honest post-project score — 0.0 to 10.0. Primary elevation driver. Generator derives peak/valley/neutral from this — no manual terrain field needed.
projects[].headline	string	Yes	One-line emotional headline — displayed at the path node in both zoom modes.
projects[].worked_well[]	string[]	Yes	What worked well. 2–4 items. Source: retrospective.
projects[].tricky[]	string[]	Yes	What was harder than expected. 2–3 items.
projects[].proud_of[]	string[]	Yes	What you are most proud of. 1–3 items.
projects[].self_assessment{}	object	Yes	Replaces separate exceeded_expectations and fell_short fields. Two subfields: exceeded[] (1–2 items where output surpassed your own bar) and fell_short[] (1–2 items, honest). Consolidated to avoid duplication with worked_well and tricky.

projects[].showcase_candidate	boolean	Yes	true / false — is this a thepmddev.com showcase candidate?
projects[].showcase_note	string	Yes	One sentence — why it is or is not a showcase candidate. Renamed from showcase_rationale for brevity.
projects[].skills_gained[]	string[]	Yes	Discrete skills gained or materially strengthened this project.
projects[].tools_used[]	string[]	Yes	Tools used — e.g. 'ReportLab', 'React', 'GA4'.
projects[].content_log_items[]	string[]	Yes — min 1	Tier-1 content atoms captured this project. Promoted to required — optional fields do not get filled. Minimum one entry per project.
projects[].next_project_intent	string	Yes	One sentence — intended next project at time of this entry. Promoted to required. The gap between intent and actuals over time is meaningful data.
horizon[]	array	Yes — min 1	Forward-looking array of upcoming projects. Provides the runway ahead that the infographic renders as a dashed projected path. Each entry: id, name, status ('queued' or 'in-progress'). Distinct visual treatment from completed solid path nodes.

4 · Example Entry — P0 Seed Record

The JSON file is seeded with P0 at first creation. Every project close adds one entry. The structure below is the complete P0 seed — replace placeholder values with actuals when populating PMD_Sentiment_Data.json.

```
{
  "schema_version": "1.1",
  "generated": "2026-05-01",
  "journey": {
    "origin": "P0 · Portfolio Shell",
    "destination": "Full-Stack PM · Hired"
  },
  "projects": [
    {
      "id": "P0",
      "name": "Portfolio Shell",
      "phase_range": "Phases 1-9",
      "completed": "May 2026",
      "duration": "approx. 8 sessions",
      "classification": "portfolio",
      "confidence_score": 1.0,
      "headline": "System exists. First product shipped. The path begins.",
      "worked_well": [
```

```

"PMD system held structure across all 9 phases without breaking down",
"WAG 2.2 AA delivered non-negotiably",
"Session summaries enabled clean context handoff every session"
],
"tricky": [
"Sketch image positioning required many iteration cycles",
"Responsive CSS took longer than estimated"
],
"proud_of": [
"Shipped a live URL from a standing start",
"16 approved artifacts across 9 phases – complete cycle"
],
"self_assessment": {
"exceeded": [
"PMD SKILL.md created – system now self-documenting and portable"
],
"fell_short": [
"Draft-first protocol not active at P0 – coach led rather than user"
]
},
"showcase_candidate": true,
"showcase_note": "Demonstrates complete 9-phase process and live deployment.",
"skills_gained": ["ReportLab PDF generation", "WAG 2.2 AA", "CI/CD via Netlify"],
"tools_used": ["HTML/CSS/JS", "ReportLab", "GA4", "Microsoft Clarity", "Netlify"],
"content_log_items": ["P0 launch build log – X.com pinned post"],
"next_project_intent": "P1 – TBD after six system additions complete"
}
],
"horizon": [
{ "id": "P1", "name": "TBD – pending kickoff", "status": "queued" }
]
}

```

5 · Infographic Visual Specification

5.1 · Layout — Horizontal Hiker Path

The infographic is horizontal landscape orientation. Left anchor: small village in foothills — labeled with `journey.origin`. Right anchor: distant mountain summit — labeled with `journey.destination`. Between them: a winding path whose elevation is driven by each project's `confidence_score`. Higher score = path rises. Lower score = path dips. The hiker avatar sits at the most recent project node.

5.2 · Zoom Levels — Two Output Modes

Mode	Projects shown	Detail level	Primary use case
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Narrow · Current State	Previous 3–5 projects + next 1–2 projected	Full retro bullets visible at each node. Headline + worked well + tricky + proud of.	Homepage feature · Blog hero banner · Social post asset
Wide · Macro Arc	All projects from P0 forward	Headline only at each node. Confidence score visible. Full terrain arc readable.	Phase group retrospective · Executive Case Study visual · Journey page

5.3 · Path Node Anatomy

Element	Source field	Rendered as
Node marker	confidence_score (derived)	Circle — green when score >= 6.0 · amber when 3.0–5.9 · muted red when < 3.0. Terrain derived by generator — no manual peak_valley field.
Project label	id + name	'P1 · Project Name' — above or below node depending on path elevation
Duration badge	duration	Small label at node — e.g. '6 weeks'. Visible in wide macro mode.
Emotional headline	headline	Italic caption beneath project label
Confidence score	confidence_score	Small badge — e.g. '1.0 / 10' — visible in both zoom modes
Retro bullets	worked_well · tricky · proud_of	Compact bullet list at node — narrow mode only
Portfolio star	showcase_candidate	★ marker on node when true
Horizon nodes	horizon[]	Upcoming projects rendered as dashed path with lighter treatment — visually distinct from completed solid nodes.

6 · Output Files — Naming Convention

File	Format	Purpose
PMD_SentimentJourney_Narrow_vX.X.pdf	PDF	Print-quality narrow view. Source for PNG export.
PMD_SentimentJourney_Narrow_vX.X.png	PNG	Web asset · blog hero banner · social post · homepage feature

PMD_SentimentJourney_Wide_vX.X.pdf	PDF	Print-quality macro arc view. Archive and case study attachment.
PMD_SentimentJourney_Wide_vX.X.png	PNG	Web asset for journey page and retrospective posts
PMD_Sentiment_Data.json	JSON	Permanent data source. Lives at repo root. Never deleted.
generate_sentiment_infographic.py	Python	Generator script. Reads JSON. Accepts --mode narrow wide --version flags.

7 · React Interactive Component — Scoped for Later

An interactive React version of the Sentiment Journey Diary is scoped but not yet built. It reads from the same PMD_Sentiment_Data.json data source. No new data entry is required when the component is eventually built — the JSON is the single source of truth for both outputs.

Feature	Description	Priority
Zoom slider	Toggle between narrow current-state view and wide macro arc	P0 v2 build
Node hover / tap	Expand full retro content for any project node on interaction	P0 v2 build
Live data binding	Reads PMD_Sentiment_Data.json directly — updates automatically when new entries are added	P0 v2 build
Export trigger	Button to trigger PDF/PNG snapshot generation from current view state	Later
Journey page embed	Component embedded on dedicated thepmdev.com/journey page	P0 v2 build

8 · Process — When and How to Update

Trigger	Action	Who
Project close — every project P0 through Pn	Add one entry to PMD_Sentiment_Data.json. Complete all required fields. Commit to repo.	PM Dev + Coach
Infographic needed for web or social use	Run generate_sentiment_infographic.py with --mode narrow. Output PNG to assets/.	PM Dev
Phase group retrospective	Run generator with --mode wide. Attach PDF to retrospective artifact.	PM Dev + Coach

Schema change required	Update schema_version in JSON. Document field addition in PMD_DECISION_LOG.md. Update this spec to match.	Coach
React component build triggered	Reference this spec Section 7 and PMD_Sentiment_Data.json schema. No data migration required.	PM Dev

9 · Locked Decisions

Decision	Detail
Data format	JSON — best tool for structured, extensible, machine-readable data. Not .md for convenience.
Numeric rating retained	confidence_score 0.0–10.0 kept as quantitative backbone. Boring in isolation. Powerful with qualitative context.
Terrain derived from score	peak_valley removed as manual field. Generator derives node colour and terrain elevation from confidence_score. Eliminates data integrity risk from score/terrain contradictions.
self_assessment consolidation	exceeded_expectations and fell_short consolidated into self_assessment.exceeded and self_assessment.fell_short. Removes redundancy with worked_well and tricky.
content_log_items required	Promoted from optional to required, minimum one entry. Optional fields do not get filled. Content strategy is a permanent process obligation.
next_project_intent required	Promoted from optional to required. Intent vs actuals gap over time is meaningful data on the macro view.
duration required	Added as required field. Project cadence is evaluator-relevant signal on the wide macro view.
horizon array added	Forward-looking array provides the upcoming 1–2 project runway the infographic needs. Dashed visual treatment distinguishes projected from completed path.
showcase_note rename	showcase_rationale renamed to showcase_note — signals a working note, not a formal document.
PDF priority over React	PDF/PNG snapshots built first — immediate use cases confirmed. React component scoped and preserved.
Single data source	PMD_Sentiment_Data.json drives both PDF generator and future React component. No duplication.

Permanent retention	Every entry retained permanently. Wide view depends on complete unbroken history.
P() helper — all table cells	Per locked PDF pattern. All table cell content wrapped in Paragraph. VALIGN TOP. Never plain strings.

Version History

Version	Key change	Date
v1.0	Initial spec — system architecture, full JSON schema, infographic spec, zoom levels, output naming, React scope, process triggers	May 2026
v1.1	Six schema corrections applied after coach review: peak_valley removed (terrain derived from confidence_score); exceeded_expectations + fell_short consolidated into self_assessment object; content_log_items and next_project_intent promoted to required; duration field added; horizon array added for forward-looking runway; showcase_rationale renamed to showcase_note	May 2026